

Wisec - The Wise SECurity

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Monday, November 05, 2007, 22:54

Bursting Performances in Blind SQL Injection - Take 2 (Bandwidth)

Today my colleague Giorgio Fedon of [Minded Security](#), talked me about an idea regarding how to save bandwidth while exploiting [blind SQL Injection](#). His question was:

"When a pentester is trying to get the content of a DB by exploiting a blind injection how can s/he get the content-length header without effectively getting all the response body, so that s/he can save time and bandwidth?"

My answer was: "use HEAD! (in both senses :)" It came out that [RFC](#) says it's not possible to use it. Infact, Apache doesn't satisfy a HEAD request with Content-Length header in response.

```
HEAD /index.php HTTP/1.1 Host: 127.0.0.1 Accept: /
```

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK Date: Mon, 05 Nov 2007 21:00:07 GMT Server: Apache Content-Type: text/html
```

See? no Content-Length in response even if my localhost home page is 90 bytes long (as Rfc suggests). Let's try it with Range header:

```
GET /index.php HTTP/1.1 Host: 127.0.0.1 Accept: / Range: bytes=-1
```

```
HTTP/1.1 206 Partial Content Date: Mon, 05 Nov 2007 21:03:15 GMT Server: Apache Content-Range: bytes 89-89/90 Content-Length: 1 Content-Type: text/html
```

Ahhhh, so the Range header in a request will fulfill my request without sending me the whole body but with a Content-Range which shows me how big would be the body itself.

Unfortunately, not all Web Servers acts the same. IIS 6.0 doesn't follow HTTP 1.1 Rfc and simply sends the whole body in response to GET or POST requests. But..Yes there is a but. HEAD requests are fulfilled with the right Content-Length:

```
HEAD /search.aspx HTTP/1.1 Host: 127.0.0.1 Accept: / Content-Length: 22
```

```
search=all'+AND+'1'='1
```

HTTP/1.1 200 OK Date: Mon, 05 Nov 2007 21:14:00 GMT Server: Microsoft-IIS/6.0 X-Powered-By: ASP.NET Content-Length: 4790 Content-Type: text/html Expires: Mon, 05 Nov 2007 21:14:00 GMT Set-Cookie: ASPSESSIONIDSQLTCRTQA=XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX; path=/ Cache-control: private

This means that we get the length of the response body even when there's no body in response.

How to use these infos? By improving blind sql injection tools.

Often blind sql injection tools use the differences in response bodies to understand if the sql injection accomplishes a true or false response. Using Content-Length or Content-Range could improve performances a lot.

The following look up table is for server and method:

SERVER	METHOD	RANGE
IIS 6.0	HEAD	
APACHE	GET/POST	X
IBM HTTP	GET/POST	X
WEBSPPHERE	GET/POST	X

We (me and Giorgio) hope some reader will provide informations about other web servers.

[Giorgio](#), Monday, November 05, 2007, 23:16

[Stefano](#), Monday, November 05, 2007, 23:29

[floyd](#), Thursday, September 16, 2010, 15:17

[Stefano](#), Thursday, September 16, 2010, 16:25

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Wisec is written and mantained by Stefano Di Paola.

Wisec uses open standards, including XHTML, CSS2, and XML-RPC.

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